Unit title: Working with IT Software – Word Processing and Presenting Information
Unit code: F1FE 12

Unit Outline
This Unit is designed to introduce complex features of word processing and presentation application software. The candidate will gain practical experience in the use of complex features in these types of software. The Unit will also provide candidates with skills regarding the selection of appropriate software for specific tasks.
The Unit is appropriate for any candidate who wishes to enhance their IT skills in word processing and presentation application software.

Outcomes
Learners who complete this Unit will be able to:

Outcome 1
Identify complex computer application software functions.
1.1 Identify complex functions of a word processing application package.
1.2 Identify complex functions of a presentation application package.

Outcome 2
Identify complex attributes of information to meet the needs of different audiences.
2.1 Identify the need for information processing to meet the needs of different audiences.
2.2 Identify complex attributes of information.

Outcome 3
Use complex computer application software functions.
3.1 Use complex functions of a word processing application package.
3.2 Use complex functions of a presentation application package.
3.3 Use the operating system effectively with software application packages.

Outcome 4
Demonstrate and review the use of complex application software functions to produce solutions to specified tasks.
4.1 Select an application package for each specified task.
4.2 Justify choice of application package for the specified tasks.
4.3 Select appropriate complex information from a variety of sources.
4.4 Produce a solution to specified tasks.

4.5 Review the use of IT resources to produce a solution for the specified tasks and changes to improve efficiency when carrying out similar tasks in the future.

Guidance on the content

The overall aim of this Unit is to introduce the candidate to the complex functions of word processing and presentation application software. On completion of the Unit, candidates should also be able to make an informed choice as to which software to use for a particular task. The Unit is designed to be task based and it is anticipated that most of the time will be spent on practical work, although some discussion work will be required.

Outcomes 1 and 3

These Outcomes cover the complex practical use of a range of software.
It is expected that candidates undertaking this Unit will possess a working knowledge of the software application packages covered within this Unit.

- Word processing:
  This section should allow the candidate to use customising and automating tools, and techniques to produce complex documents (eg producing newsletters, journals, complex reports, form letters, form envelopes and form address labels).

- Presentation:
  This section should allow the candidate to produce technically complex and interactive presentations (eg including video and sound clips) and to structure the content to take account of different contexts and audience needs. Copyright legislation should be discussed and the importance of observing copyrighted material when importing sounds and/or video clips into a presentation should be stressed. This Unit does not require candidates to create sound/video content but candidates could be shown how to acquire sounds through the use of a microphone and to acquire video clips through the use of a digital camera. The use of a scanner to convert a picture to a digital file should also be covered, but the use of copyrighted material should be discouraged.

In Outcome 3 candidates are expected to make effective use of the operating system. It is expected that at a minimum candidates will demonstrate 'good housekeeping' by creating files and folders, using appropriate file and folder names for ease of retrieval. Candidates are also expected to locate applications and correctly execute and close as appropriate. Candidates will also start-up and shut down the system appropriately.

At this level candidates are expected to resolve fairly straight forward problems for themselves without assistance. This may be a hardware problem such as the printer being offline or a software problem such as a missing shortcut.

Outcome 2

This Outcome deals with the needs of information and the complex attributes of information as they apply to different audiences. Candidates are required to develop an understanding of the importance of producing relevant information that is appropriate for a range of audiences, in the correct format and in the right place at the right time.

Outcome 4

This Outcome deals with the candidate's ability to select an appropriate application package for a specified task.

Candidates are required to make selective use of IT. Candidates should be able to work out how to use IT effectively for technically complex tasks and purposes, taking account of their own and others skills and capabilities and the needs of organisations. This will involve working out how to use IT for technically complex tasks (eg creating an illustrated newsletter, reporting the results of a survey about clients' needs and preferences, or creating an online presentation).

Candidates should be able to identify an appropriate application package for a specific task and explain why and how using the IT system and software was an appropriate way of carrying out the task.

Having completed the tasks in Outcome 4 candidates should then review the appropriateness and effectiveness of their decisions and actions taken about the choice and use of software tools and techniques, in relation to the task or purpose involved. This will involve the candidate identifying changes that could make similar tasks easier or more successful. Candidates should be given feedback from other people regarding their use of IT and should evaluate this feedback, giving and detailing steps that could be taken to improve any weaknesses. Candidates are required to comment on the impact of their own use of IT in their review.

In their review, candidates should demonstrate ability to use a wide range of correct terms for hardware and software. Candidates should be able to provide a simple explanation of IT terms that others may find difficult to understand.

Opportunities For Core Skill Development

This Unit involves candidates:

- Using a wide range of IT and carrying out searches to extract and present relevant information which provides opportunities to gather evidence towards the IT Core Skill.
- Making selective use of IT and evaluating their choice which may provide an opportunity to gather evidence towards aspects of the Problem Solving Core Skill.
- Reporting a number of aspects of the assessment which may provide an opportunity to gather evidence towards aspects of the Communications Core Skill.